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Controversial Energy Policy Widely Criticized

N.A.A.C.P. UNDER ATTACK

(Washington, D.C.) - The National Association for the Advancement of Colored People (NAACP) is embroiled in a storm of controversy over its recent stand on a national energy policy that is strikingly similar to the position of the oil industry.

The NAACP board of directors' position paper has been widely publicized as a pro-oil industry break with the Carter administration over the need to deregulate oil and to develop nuclear energy resources.

The stand spuriously links higher gas prices with more job opportunities for unemployed Blacks.

On the other hand, in a major statement on energy policy, National Urban League (NUL) Executive Director Vernon Jordan opposed deregulation and suggested that "price controls and regulations be extended to all domestic gas and oil."

The Congressional Black Caucus (CBC) took a similar stand, directly opposed to the NAACP's. "How on earth could deregulation be in the interests of Black people?" Representative John Conyers asked. "Obviously we are the relatively largest unemployed and would be the most adversely impacted by increased energy costs."

Controversy has arisen over the fact that the NAACP report was drafted by persons closely connected to the oil industry and strongly backed by Black oil executives, many



of whom belong to the American Association of Blacks in Energy (AABE).

Tempered criticism has also pointed with some concern to NAACP Board Chairperson Margaret Bush Wilson's membership on the board of directors of the Monsanto Corporation, a company in the thick of the energy



NAACP leaders MARGARET BUSH WILSON and BENJAMIN HOOKS. The NAACP is under attack for its energy policy.

industry.

In a recent interview, Mrs. Wilson denied that her Monsanto connection had anything to do with the energy policy or that it was developed — as some have suggested — under irregular procedures.

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Pipe Ceremony On Alcatraz, Rally In Sacramento

INDIANS BEGIN "LONGEST WALK"

(Alcatraz Island, Calif.) - About 500 Native Americans and their supporters gathered here Saturday, February 11, to consecrate the start of a 3,000-mile winter trek to Washington, D.C., to protest 11 pieces of anti-Indian legislation.

Native American leader Dennis Banks explained, "Congress represents those forces which want to legally take over our land and natural resources. Each bill chips away at the sovereignty of our people."

Before embarking on what they are calling, "The Longest Walk," Indians gathered on grounds east of the old prison buildings on the site of an earlier Indian occupation of Alcatraz which ended in June, 1971.

The demonstrators then went to Sacramento to stage a rally before beginning the cross-country winter journey which is expected to last six months. By February 13, the group



Indians proceed to Alcatraz to launch "The Longest Walk."

had reached Reno, Nevada.

Of the 11 pieces of repressive legislation, the primary focus of attention has been on H.R. 9054, the deceptively named "Native American Opportunity Act," introduced by Representative Jack Cunningham of Washington state.

H.R. 9054 provides not only for the abolishment of all treaties entered into with Indian tribes by the U.S., but also for the abrogation of all rights and protections guaranteed to Indian people by these treaties, such as the rights to hunt and fish. In effect, it will terminate all federal protections of Native Americans.

A strong force behind "The Longest Walk," Banks declared at the Alcatraz gathering, "Indians consider themselves equal to other nations. We are not subordinate or a

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